

Helena Corain

Player-facing description

Helena Corain: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood.

Public role

Elderly climber and respected mountain-crab egg merchant

Handout text

Player-safe note: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood.

GM truth

No forced reveal. Let this entity disclose truth through scene context and player attention.

GM handling

Use this person to put a human face on the current pressure. Give them one concrete want before exposition.

Mechanics

- Title: Social / Information Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can interact, comfort, persuade, or earn trust Helena Corain when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-helena-corain-engage-helena-corain entity-helena-corain Engage Helena Corain Engage Helena Corain Presence Knowledge Instinct Presence Knowledge, Instinct 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of Helena Corain hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. A...
- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal

without closing off player agency.

- Condition Options: No official condition unless the fiction calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Search yields context first: spoor, warning marks, tool scratches, route signs, or local testimony unless a scene names treasure.

Profile

- Schema Version: npc-profile-v1
- Source: NPC_System_Packet + image-informed hardening
- Backup: False
- Combatant: False
- Player Safe: Helena Corain A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood. An elderly climber smiles with wind-cut confidence, grey braids tied in climbing cord and a basket of pale mountain-crab eggs tucked safely against her shoulder. Helena Corain: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood.
- Block1: Helena Corain heh-LAY-nuh koh-RAYN A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood. Elderly climber and respected mountain-crab egg merchant Use as a role-first conversation handle, clue source, or pressure valve. Helena Corain gives the table a visible person attached to The Sable Sinecure, The Titan's Steps, Mountain Crabs. Start with sensory detail, then let questions earn the name and motive. A question to ask A local perspective A grounded reason this place matters A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood.; at the table, give Helena Corain one visible object, one bodily habit, and one protected attachment tied to The Sable Sinecure, The Titan's Steps, Mountain Crabs. Respect the person's immediate want before asking for lore.
- Block2: Sell good eggs, warn fools off bad rock, and see who respects the climb. Keep mountain work honorable in a market that wants every risk cheap. Sell good eggs, warn fools off bad rock, and see who respects the climb. Keep mountain work honorable in a market that wants every risk cheap. Wind-cut confidence with nothing left to prove and everything left to protect. Stopped charging children for eggs after one hungry winter. Cannot abide a young climber trusting a posted safety notice over their own grip. That rock will kill you politely. Listen to me instead of the sign. Eggs are fair price. The advice is free, because I am old. You climb with your hands, not with a guarantee. Remember it. She knows which routes companies abandoned after taking the easy profit. Young climbers trusting a posted assurance more than their hands. Calluses, clean knots, egg care, and people who admit when they...
- Block3: Helena expects travelers to underestimate old bodies and overestimate new notices. Practical respect lands. A good knot earns more than a good speech. Presence 12 They give one practical answer tied to their existing summary or role. She fights by terrain, rope, and timing if forced.
- Block4: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood. Keep Helena Corain's deeper answers tied to existing page facts: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs

the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood. Suspicious of any company that sells safety without climbing the route. Helena Corain localizes the Atlas entry through daily work, visible belongings, and pressure from The Sable Sinecure, The Titan's Steps, Mountain Crabs. If the table cares about Helena Corain, let one object, favor, or local warning point back to The Sable Sinecure, The Titan's Steps, Mountain Crabs without creating a new plot engine. Any PC may engage; no PC-specific plot dependency. Can make frontier labor feel skilled, old, and socially embedded. npc_images portrait asset

- Block5: noncombat NPC NPC profile interaction model; run as social, clue, consent, or pressure play unless a scene explicitly turns violent Social / noncombat Conversation, clue, pressure, or consent gate Social NPC 12 Social threshold: one clear concession, clue, or boundary shift at Difficulty 12 Social stakes only; no HP track unless a scene assigns an adversary profile. Social stakes only; use scene Stress/Fear rules if pressure escalates. Conversation only; no attack modifier unless a scene assigns an adversary profile. Social pressure: name what they want, offer the listed trait/DC move, and let the result change access, trust, timing, or information. Disposition: A direct, affable, brave human who free-climbs the Titan's Steps and commands more respect than most locals of the wood.; at the table, give Helena Corain one visible object, one bodily habit, and one protected attachment...
- Portrait: assets/npc-images/helena-corain/portrait_base.png assets/npc-images/helena-corain/portrait_chroma.png assets/npc-images/helena-corain/portrait_transparent.png npc_images
- Imagine It Like: Think the legendary old mountain guide who has forgotten more about the rock than you will ever learn, the salty elder everyone defers to, the grandmother who could still free-solo if she felt like it.
- Fullbody: assets/npc-images/helena-corain/fullbody_base.png assets/npc-images/helena-corain/fullbody_chroma.png assets/npc-images/helena-corain/fullbody_transparent.png

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